

Case Study Brooklyn

Background

Brooklyn is a 16 year-old-boy. He lives with foster parents and their children who are very involved with his life. His foster family bring Brooklyn to events, walks in the community and shopping – he is very involved. Brooklyn sees his biological mother once-a-month which is very difficult for him. This can lead to explosive behaviour for his foster parents such as punching walls, kicking in doors and screaming. The school team has also reported that his week at school can be more difficult. Both the school team and foster parents want what is best for Brooklyn.

S.E.

School Information

Brooklyn is part of the ACCESS program where he works on emotional regulation and life skills. He is out in the community daily and participates in the school's foods programme where he learns how to cook and do laundry. He is very good at repetitive tasks like folding laundry, stocking shelves and wiping down tables. He is responsible for completing the weekly school recycling program and brings the bottles and cans to the local recycling depot. He loves this as after he can buy a Slurpee at the local 7-11. He also loves business cards and brochures and will stare and read at them for a long time. He really thinks it's neat to have a job where you can hand out a card. Brooklyn is also learning how to use a daily planner to organize his school day. He likes to carry it into classes, so he looks like the other kids.

The school team and foster parents are very happy with Brooklyn's progress. However, there are some challenges during his school day. When on walks, Brooklyn will ask to go into the town's visitor centre since he loves business cards and brochures. If he sees that the business card section is full, he will start to take all the cards and put them in his pockets. The EA then has to escort Brooklyn out of the visitor centre. This is difficult and can sometimes make Brooklyn very angry.

At school, Brooklyn and another student, Teddy do not get along. When Brooklyn and Teddy are in the same group for their daily reading time, Brooklyn will appear to be anxious. If Teddy asks Brooklyn what is wrong, Brooklyn will yell at Teddy at a very high volume. The EA or the teacher break up the group and read to Brooklyn and Teddy separately. This is often difficult as other students require assistance at the same time – they do not think this is a long-term solution.

Lastly, Brooklyn finds writing tasks hard as his fine motor skills are poor and this makes it difficult for him to hold a pen/pencil. It is a requirement that students write in their journal daily. When asked to write in his journal, Brooklyn will ask to go to the washroom and spend upwards of 25 minutes in there. His EA knocks on the door and tell Brooklyn to hurry up. They are worried because Brooklyn is missing a large portion of his journal block.